

The New Nature - Born From Above

Open to John 1. We have been establishing ourselves in the two births: the first, the natural birth, and the second, the rebirth.

We began with the man who was born blind. The disciples asked Jesus, "Was it this man or his parents that he was born blind?"

Jesus said, "No, it was not him, nor his parents."

I could have understood possibly his parents, although the sins of the parents are not visited upon the children in that way. You have your own life. Someone says, "My mama..." Well, you got born again now. It is not your mama anymore. It is what you do with what you received and what you hear.

Hallelujah.

They asked Him, "Whose fault is it?"

He said, "It was not him or his parents."

Then why was he born blind? Jesus was talking about the misfortune of being born of a fallen race.

When He explained this to Nicodemus, He said:

"That which is born of the flesh is flesh; and that which is born of the Spirit is spirit.
Ye must be born again."

Nicodemus took a totally natural view. He asked, "Must I enter my mother's womb a second time?"

Jesus said, "No. What is born of flesh is flesh. You have already been born."

The first birth is when your spirit came into existence. That little spirit grew at the same rate as your body, cell for cell. Aborting the baby does no good, because even though the body may be cut out, the little spirit will continue to grow, only in heaven.

When God gave Adam the commandment through the law of Genesis, "Be fruitful, multiply, and replenish the earth," that is when this law of procreation was established.

Because of the transgression of one man, sin entered the world, and death by sin. That one man passed spiritual death to the whole human race. It does not matter what you are born under. Flesh is producing flesh, and the first birth of that spirit is by flesh.

God does not create little spirits in heaven and send them here to grow up and go to hell. He wants to populate heaven. If He were going to populate heaven simply by creating little human spirits, then He would leave them in heaven. Why send them here to go through a cycle, die, and go to hell?

Your little spirit came into existence at the moment of conception, of procreation. That little spirit grows, is born, and lives in a state of innocence until it enters the state of accountability.

So the man born blind simply had the misfortune of being born of a fallen race. Because he was born of a fallen race, he happened to be born blind.

Jesus went on to say:

"I must work the works of him that sent me, while it is day: the night cometh, when no man can work."

The night He was talking about was not just the three days He would be dead. The rebirth and the baptism of the Holy Spirit would come into the earth, and now we are doing His works. The night that is coming, when no man can work, is when it is all over. People who will be in hell will be in hell, and people who are born again will be in heaven. Salvation will stop. The eternal night will come, and no one will be saved anymore.

The light started with Him. He said, "I must do the works of Him who sent Me while it is day, because this night is coming."

Then He stepped up, spit on the ground, made clay, anointed the man's eyes, told him to go wash, and he came back seeing. That was the works of Him who sent Him.

Now that you have a covenant, you can believe for the children you will have. They do not have to be born blind or without limbs. The whole world in general is flesh randomly producing flesh. Children are born in all kinds of states: without arms, without faces, without legs, with deformities you would not believe. That is random flesh producing flesh.

But Jesus told Nicodemus that what is born of flesh is flesh, and what is born of spirit is spirit. In your second birth, when you were born again, you received an inheritance from God. In that birth, we are born equal. Hallelujah.

We are born with an inheritance, and everything we have coming from God we can receive through our inheritance.

After you believed, Ephesians says you were sealed with the Holy Spirit of promise against the redemption of the purchased possession. The purchased possession is not heaven. Heaven is not being redeemed. We are being redeemed. We are the purchased possession.

God came after you were born again and sealed you with the Holy Ghost of promise against the day He would finish purchasing the possession, which is you.

First, my spirit is born again. Then my soul is renewed. Then I receive a glorified body. Then I am a manifested son of God, the adoption process made complete: spirit, soul, and resurrected body.

Meanwhile, when I believed and my spirit was born again, I received my full inheritance. The seal of the Holy Ghost was put on me when I was baptized and began to speak with tongues. He is the earnest of my inheritance.

In other words, He has come to say:

"You are the possession being purchased, and I am the earnest sent to ensure heaven will receive the full prize of your possession."

You are a son of God, and you mean something to Him.

You might as well know that to ensure your success, God gave the Holy Spirit a supernatural language to give you. Every time you pray in tongues, you pray another portion of your inheritance into existence.

If you do not have arms, legs, or eyes, in our covenant and inheritance those things have been made available to you. They were put on deposit in you when you were born again.

If you let the Holy Ghost take everything Christ has made you and bring it forward, nobody and nothing can stop it. But you have to let Him get in there and bring everything you are forward.

Nothing can stop it. Hallelujah.

That is why sin has lost its dominion, along with all the friends and cohorts of sin. Sickness and disease are the result of man dying spiritually. So are depression and poverty. Everything taken away from the human race was taken away as a result of spiritual death.

The moment you were born again, sin lost dominion over you. It does not have the power to dominate you anymore.

When I justify things that defeat me, when I justify sin that I am doing, what I am really doing is taking away from the Holy Spirit what He needs from me to walk my freedom out.

When I justify failure, I take away from the Holy Spirit what He needs from me to come in and walk my victory out.

When I stand there and say, "I just could not help it. I had to," that is not true. You had what you needed on the inside to help it.

When you say, "That had more power than I did," the only thing the Holy Spirit has to work with is your new nature, and you have taken away from Him what He needed. But when you say, "Sin does not have dominion over me, and I do not care how messed up I am, I want the angels and God to know it does not have dominion over me," the Holy Ghost says, "Good. That is all I need to take you from where you are to where you are going."

Until we find that out, we will sit around justifying our failures. No, thank you. I had enough years of that.

Now we are entering into an exciting part. John 1:1 says:

"In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God.
The same was in the beginning with God."

In the beginning was the Word, the Logos. This was Jesus in eternity past, whom we now know as the glorified Man Jesus, our Lord, Savior, and Redeemer.

The Logos was with God. He stood face to face, coequal with the other two members of the Godhead. He was God.

This is the same beginning as Genesis 1:1:

"In the beginning God created the heaven and the earth."

In the beginning, God means all three members of the Godhead operating in Their respective roles created everything that was. John is elaborating on the roles of each member of the Godhead.

He separates the second Person in the Godhead because he is about to tell His role in creation:

"All things were made by him; and without him was not any thing made that was made."

The Greek puts a pigtail on it: not one single thing.

John 1:10 says:

"He was in the world, and the world was made by him, and the world knew him not."

The mighty Logos, whom you and I know and love as Jesus, is also Creator. The Father planned everything that is. Jesus created it. The Holy Spirit has taken the role of creation, regeneration, and sustaining.

In Genesis, the earth was replenished and made habitable for man to inhabit it again. Somewhere in eternity past, God passed through this sector and created everything that was in the beginning. We do not know the lapse of time between the original beginning and the recreation or replenishment of the earth to make it habitable for man.

Some theologians believe there was life on the planet at that time. I think the dinosaurs existed sometime between the destruction of that first world and the replenishment in Genesis when the Holy Ghost came in, regenerated the earth, separated the firmament, ignited the sun and moon, and made the earth habitable for God to replenish it.

Whatever was on the earth the first time, I do not know. But I know the Holy Ghost takes the role of regeneration.

The Logos stood face to face, coequal, eyes to eyes, absolutely tri-equal with the other two members of the Godhead. All things were made by Him.

All of a sudden, in John 1:4, John switches from Jesus' deity to His humanity and His soon-to-be glorified humanity:

"In him was life; and the life was the light of men."

He is glorified now at the right hand of the Father. Thank God. Hallelujah. I am soon going to be glorified too.

Hebrews says:

"He that sanctifieth and they who are sanctified are all of one: for which cause he is not ashamed to call them brethren."

He who sanctifies is Jesus, and I am one who is sanctified. We are of one. For this reason, Jesus is not ashamed to call me His brother.

In His humanity, I am His brother. In His glorified humanity, I am His brother. But I will never approach His deity. He is the only glorified Man who is as much Man as He is God and as much God as He is Man.

I will never excel beyond my glorified humanity. But that still makes me a brother to the glorified humanity of Jesus, in the family of God, a full inheritor with Jesus. I choose to start now. I am going to receive everything I have coming now, which is everything I have coming as a human being.

John 1:4 says, "In Him was life." What life was in Him? This is talking about His humanity, not His deity.

The life in Him was His human spirit, the first human spirit since Adam to be born spiritually alive. That life became our light.

When I was born again, the same light God lit Jesus' spirit with when He raised Him from the dead, He lit my spirit with. I was quickened together with Him.

The word "quicken" always refers to a spirit. Resurrection refers to the human body. When God resurrected people in the Old Testament, He took their spirit from Abraham's bosom, put it back into the regenerated body, and they were resurrected.

But quickening refers to spirit. When Scripture says Abraham stood before Him who quickens the dead and calls those things that be not as though they were, God was talking about the promise He made to Abraham that in his Seed all nations would be blessed. He was asking, "Do you believe I can take His spirit, quicken it, and bring it from death to life?"

Abraham said yes. God accounted righteousness to him and called those things that were not, his human spirit as dead as a doornail, as though they were alive. Abraham could whip the devil on credit, and God would pay it in full in the resurrection.

Jesus was the first Man to be born spiritually alive since Adam because that was what would be sacrificed for you. That was what would die and what you would identify with so you could also be resurrected with Him.

In Him was life, and that life was the light of men.

The only thing that will expel darkness is light. You have been translated out of darkness into the kingdom of His dear Son. The same light He lit Jesus' spirit with, He lit your spirit with. You now have a capacity to understand God.

Darkness has been expelled.

Hello, son of God. Hello, daughter of God. I have been born again.

John 1:5 says:

"And the light shineth in darkness; and the darkness comprehended it not."

Jesus came and walked among spiritually dead men, and they could not comprehend Him.

Proverbs says:

"The spirit of man is the candle of the Lord, searching all the inward parts of the belly."

That is a prophecy of our covenant. Your new nature is finally what God can use to illuminate you with Himself, searching all the inward parts of the belly.

I have been lit. Hallelujah.

The light shone in darkness, and the darkness comprehended it not. God sent a man with revelation of who Jesus was. There was a man sent from God whose name was John. He came to bear witness of the light, so all men through that light might believe.

John was not the light. He was sent to bear witness of the light. He was saying, "This is Him. He is here. This is the light. He is the Savior of the world. The first Man to be born spiritually alive. This is Him."

And darkness comprehended it not.

John 1:9 says:

"That was the true Light, which lighteth every man that cometh into the world."

I have been lit by that light. But many of my teachers kept me in darkness. Now the limit is off. The Holy Ghost has truly become my Teacher.

The best gift any teacher can give you is to teach you how to turn yourself over to the Teacher. The servant is not above his master. The disciple is not above his master. Disciple means follower, and he will not be above the teacher.

Organizations will take you out on their limb, and that is where they stop. They make you just like them. What is the penalty for not being like them? Expulsion. Even preaching faith can get you thrown out of some Holy Ghost circles because you are not like them anymore.

But get under a teacher who teaches you how to turn yourself over to the Holy Ghost, and He is the Teacher of teachers. His commission is, "I will not even speak of Myself. Whatsoever I hear, that will I speak. I will say nothing except what glorifies Jesus."

If He becomes your Teacher, who are you going to become like?

John 1:9 does not mean every baby's spirit is born spiritually alive. Children are born in a state of innocence, and their sins are not imputed to them. But every person has inherited Adam's death. Jesus is the true Light who lights every person who comes into the world when that person receives salvation and the rebirth.

John 1:10-13 says:

"He was in the world, and the world was made by him, and the world knew him not.

He came unto his own, and his own received him not.

But as many as received him, to them gave he power to become the sons of God, even to them that believe on his name:

Which were born, not of blood, nor of the will of the flesh, nor of the will of man, but of God."

He came to His own, the Jews, and His own received Him not. But as many as received Him, He gave power through that new nature to become sons of God.

It is not those born of blood, not Jewish descent. It is not those born of the will of the flesh, random families producing children. It is not the will of man, planned lines and procreation acts that result in an eternal creature called a child.

It does not matter how you got into this world. The power to become a son of God belongs to those born of God.

Then John says:

"And the Word was made flesh, and dwelt among us."

They beheld the glory of the only One who carried a spirit born spiritually alive. He was the only begotten. But it would not be long before there would be many.

Hallelujah.

Go to Second Corinthians 5. Now that you understand this, you can understand verse 14:

"For the love of Christ constraineth us; because we thus judge, that if one died for all, then were all dead:

And that he died for all, that they which live should not henceforth live unto themselves, but unto him which died for them, and rose again.

Wherefore henceforth know we no man after the flesh:

yea, though we have known Christ after the flesh, yet now henceforth know we him no more.

Therefore if any man be in Christ, he is a new creature:

old things are passed away; behold, all things are become new."

Paul was teaching the Corinthians, pagans outside the covenants and promises as far as the oracles of God went. He taught them about Moses and how we have the ministry of the Spirit, not like Moses, who had to wear a veil over his face. We use great plainness of speech.

Now we do not have a veil over us, which is spiritual death hiding us from the full revelation of Christ. At the end of Second Corinthians 3, Paul says we look as in a mirror with no veil over our face. Because we have been born again and have a new nature to look at God through, He can conform us from glory to glory into His image.

The veil over Moses' face was a type of spiritual death. It made it impossible for them to see the full revelation of the Ten Commandments. Although they could not see it, they were commanded to keep it, and that brought condemnation. Paul called the Ten Commandments the ministration of death engraved in stones because the Jews could not keep them without a nature to keep them.

But we are not like Moses. We have no veil over our face because we have been born again. We can see God clearly because we have His nature.

When Paul says, "Henceforth know we no man after the flesh," he is not only talking about the branches of the old man and old nature. He is also talking about the root.

What old things have passed away? The Old Covenant. What has become new? The New Covenant. The new order is this: God was in Christ reconciling the world to Himself.

John 1 explained it. Jesus came to His own, and they received Him not. But to as many as received Him, He gave power to become sons of God, not those born of blood, not Jewish descent, not the will of man, but of God.

The Old Covenant bloodline distinctions were cut off. Henceforth we know no man after the flesh, not Greek, Scythian, Jew, or any descent of bloodline. The whole world is now being reconciled to God through Christ. I have been born again and become a son of God.

The first birth was of flesh. The second birth is from above.

This world is producing random flesh by the billions. Children grow past the age of innocence, where their sins are no longer imputed, and they are going to hell by the millions. Now God is in Christ reconciling the world, and we have had the privilege of this great commission placed into our hands. It is the only thing I live for.

Now that you have been born again, your spirit did not come into the kingdom of God knowing everything. But you have been translated out of darkness. You have a capacity to be taught. You have a capacity to understand spiritual things now. That is why He sent you the Holy Spirit as your Teacher.

If you will quit justifying your failures, you will give the Holy Ghost something to work with.

When you were born again, you were still a separate individual from the Holy Spirit. He is one Person, and you are another. You do not automatically know everything He knows because you received the baptism of the Holy Spirit. But you can be taught.

The same way one person transfers knowledge to another, the Holy Spirit must transfer His knowledge to you through guiding and teaching.

Jesus said in John 16:13:

"Howbeit when he, the Spirit of truth, is come, he will guide you into all truth: for he shall not speak of himself; but whatsoever he shall hear, that shall he speak: and he will show you things to come."

When He comes into our new nature through baptism, He comes to teach us and guide us into all truth, much like a teacher transferring knowledge in a classroom. When you entered the classroom, you did not automatically know everything the teacher knew. It had to be taught to you.

When you were born again, you received a new nature that could be taught and could understand spiritual things. He removed the darkness from your spirit and sent you the Teacher of all teachers, the Instructor of your wisdom and the Teacher of your new nature, to give you what no man can give you.

What happened in your spirit, causing you to be able to understand spiritual things, was phenomenal. It could be compared to knowing not one word of Japanese and then taking a college course on the theory of relativity from a Japanese professor who speaks no English. You would have no idea what he was talking about. But the Japanese students would know because they were born into that culture.

In order for you to understand the Japanese professor, being American, you would have to understand the Japanese culture. In a manner of speaking, you would almost have to be born into that culture.

The miracle of all miracles happened when you were born again. In the twinkling of an eye, in a moment of time, God did the impossible. He took the darkness out of your spirit and made it possible for you to understand light.

Colossians 1:13 says:

"Who hath delivered us from the power of darkness, and hath translated us into the kingdom of his dear Son."

A person who has never been born again has no more capacity to understand spiritual things than a person has to understand the Japanese language if he has never been subjected to that language or culture.

When we were born again, we received a new nature and a capacity to understand spiritual things. When we were filled with the Holy Spirit, we received the Professor, and now we are able to understand spiritual things as He unveils the mysteries of Christ.

First Corinthians 2:14 says:

"But the natural man receiveth not the things of the Spirit of God: for they are foolishness unto him:
neither can he know them, because they are spiritually discerned."

Here we are, born-again children of God with a nature that not only knows God but can be taught by God. But our soul, our mind, will, intellect, and emotions, has only been trained by this world and knows no other way to operate.

In a stroke of genius, God gave our soul something it could feed on. He left behind a legacy: sixty-six books full of the thoughts of God. He saw to it that His Word, the Holy Bible, would be given to us so that everything the Holy Spirit is trying to get over to us as our Teacher, we can go to the Word of God and find it with our mind and acknowledge it with our intellect.

So here we are with the Teacher of all teachers living inside us, attempting to guide us into all truth. He does so in great hopes that we will give our soul over to the meditation of God's Word.

The combination of the Holy Spirit ministering insight and wisdom in your spirit, and you willingly subjecting your mind and soul to the Word of God in meditation, results in the kind of transformation that will change your life forever, put you on the immovable rock of the Word of God, transform your soul, and give you great courage and success to face life and conquer.